Checkout UI & Acceptance Standards

User-facing behavior, accessibility and acceptance guidance

Document status: CURRENT unless otherwise identified | Enterprise delivery assurance training corpus

1. Purpose

Northstar Commerce is preparing a multi-release modernization of its digital commerce platform. This specification is intentionally detailed and includes overlapping business, API, testing, and governance content so that delivery-assurance systems must reason across multiple artifacts rather than rely on one isolated paragraph.

This standard supplements product requirements with user-facing acceptance expectations. It should be used together with current product and payment specifications.

1.1 Operational Guidance

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2. Validation and Error Presentation

Validation should identify actionable fields without exposing internal implementation details. Error summaries must remain understandable and keyboard accessible.

UI State	User Message Expectation	Test Note
Validation error	Specific field guidance	Assert field + summary
Payment decline	Actionable but non-sensitive	Do not expose processor internals
Dependency timeout	Do not imply transaction failed	Guide retry only after status reconciliation
Duplicate submit	Show existing outcome where known	Verify no duplicate order/payment

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3. Transaction Uncertainty

When a transaction outcome is uncertain because a downstream dependency timed out, the interface must avoid telling the user that payment definitely failed until state reconciliation completes.

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4. Accessibility Acceptance

Interactive controls require accessible names, keyboard operability, visible focus, and appropriate error association.

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5. Acceptance Evidence

UI acceptance may include automated browser assertions, accessibility scans, screenshots, and targeted manual evidence for complex interaction behavior.

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